



State Employment Leadership Network



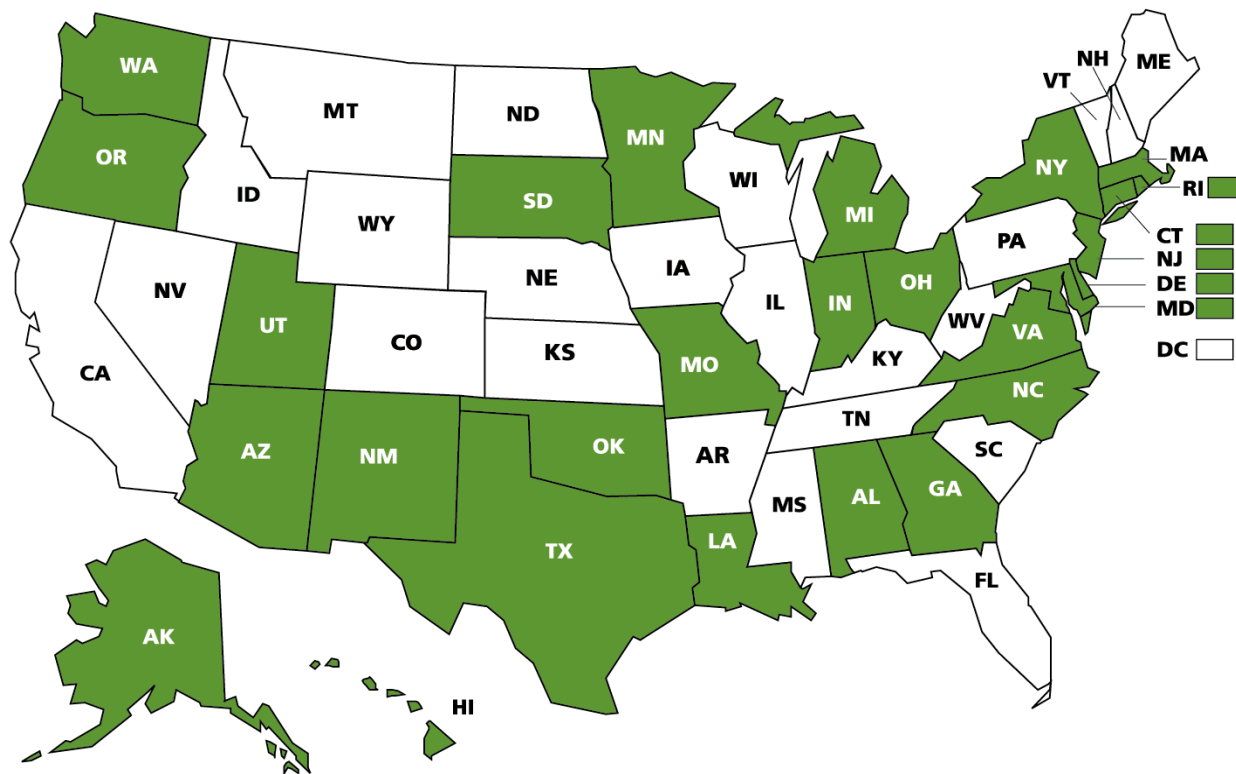
Launching Leaders: Building Your Path Forward

- Convening
- Operationalizing
- Bridging
- Reporting
- Optimizing
- Policy refinement/interpretation
- Systems capacity building (TCM, providers, etc.)
- Building a team and foundation

Introductions

- Name
- Title
- State
- Favorite weekend activity

SELN Member States 2025-2026



Vulnerability

"... the emotion that we experience during times of uncertainty, risk, and emotional exposure..."

-Brené Brown, Dare to Lead

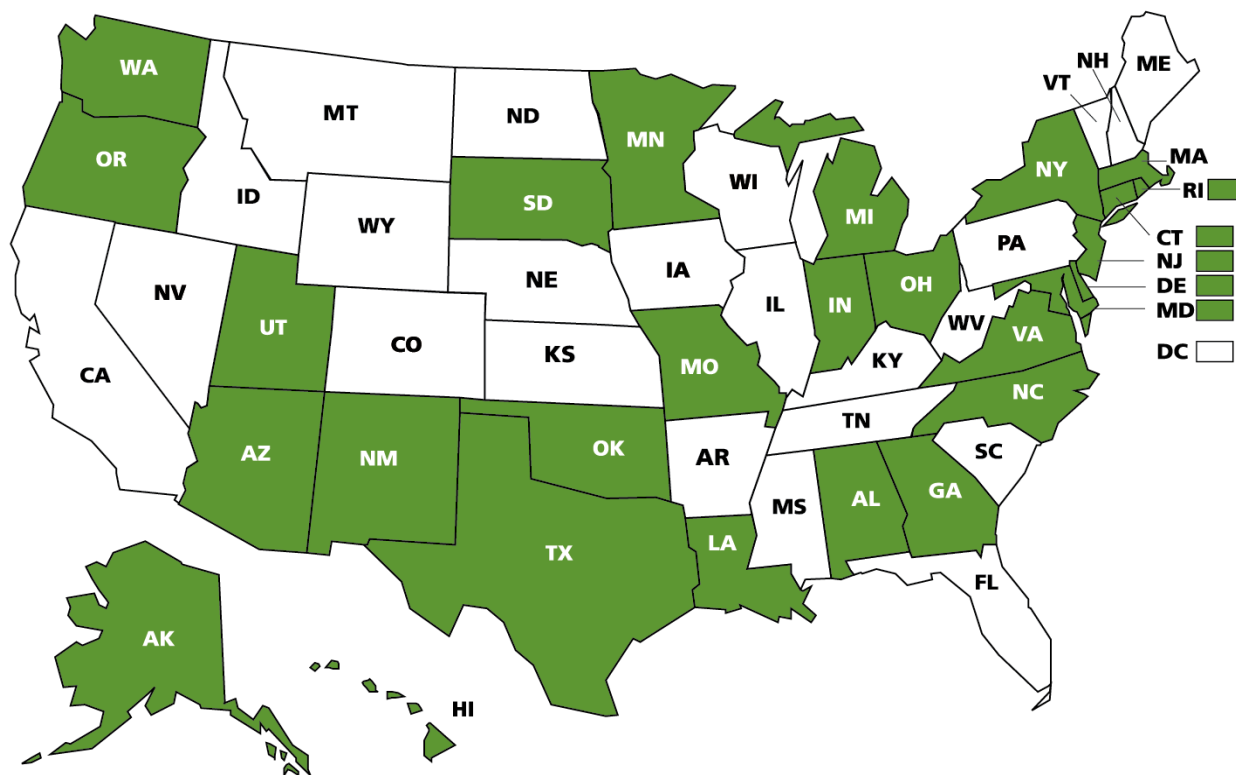
Behaviors and Cultural Issues that Leaders Say Get in the Way:

- Avoiding tough conversations and constructive feedback
- Diminished trust due to lack of connection and empathy
- Not taking smart risks and sharing bold ideas
- Perfectionism and fear that keep people from learning and growing

Introductions 2

- Name
- Why you do this work?
- What keeps you inspired?

**SELN Member States
2025-2026**



Exercise 1: Armored Leadership vs Daring Leadership

"Courage is contagious. To scale daring leadership and build courage in teams and organizations, we have to cultivate a culture in which brave work, tough conversations, and whole hearts are the expectation, and armor is not necessary or rewarded."

- Brené Brown

Live into your Values

- Review list and mark all that apply
- Reduce to a list of 5
- Turn to a partner and randomly cross off 2

Values at work

- How do your values show up at work?
- How do you empower others, so their values show up at work?

Effective Communication

- What do you need from your leadership?
- How do you ask for it?
- How do you know what your leadership needs from you?
- How do you respond?

Scenarios

Your organization has a new director.

How do you learn their values while supporting them to understand your projects/initiatives?

You are starting a new project/ initiative.

How do you demonstrate your values and invite your team to work collaboratively?

Wrap up

- Daring Leadership Assessment:

<https://daretolead.brenebrown.com/assessment/>

- Meet again to continue these conversations?



State Employment Leadership Network

The SELN is a place for states to connect, collaborate, and create cross-community support regarding pressing employment-related issues at state and federal levels for individuals with developmental disabilities.

The SELN was launched in 2006 as a joint program of the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services and the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston.

UMass
Boston



www.selnhub.org